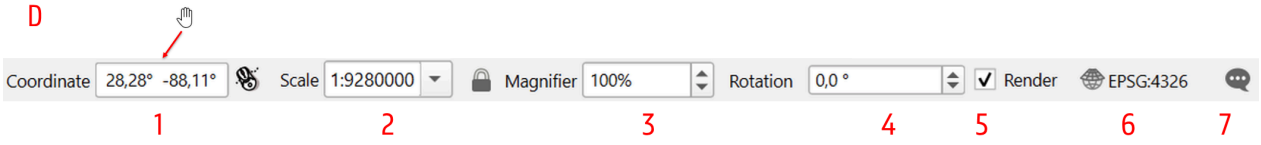
3.4 The status bar

D: Status bar (coordinates & scale)



D1	**Coordinate**	Shows you the coordinates of the point your mouse is hovering over at that moment. These are two values, one for the position from west to east (x) and one for the position from south to north (y). See the chapter on coordinate systems.
D2	**Scale**	Shows you the scale that is used in the map canvas at that moment. The scale shows how much smaller (or, in exceptional cases, larger) the real world appears in your map canvas. Scale is usually shown as a ratio (1:...). In the example above, the scale is 1:9280000. This means that one centimetre on your screen corresponds to 9280000 centimetres (or 92.8 km) in the real world. When you zoom in or out, you will see the scale change automatically. You can also change the scale here manually.
D3	**Magnifier**	Shows how much you magnify your map canvas. By default this is set to 100%. The magnifier enlarges the image in your map canvas, like a magnifying glass, but it does not zoom in: everything simply becomes larger, and you do not see more detail. **Warning** If you magnify your map canvas to, for example, 200%, the scale shown no longer matches what you see: everything on your screen is twice as large, so a scale of 1:10000 then really looks like 1:5000. Unless you have a specific reason for it, leave the *Magnifier* at 100%.
D4	**Rotation**	Shows the rotation of your map. By default, north is at the top of the map canvas; the rotation is then 0°. If you want to change this, you can adjust the rotation. If you set 90° here, for example, west will be at the top of the map canvas. In practice, this setting is not often changed, and the convention is that north is at the top of the map.
D5	**Render**	While you work, QGIS keeps the map canvas up to date: every time you pan or zoom, it works out on the fly what has to be shown and draws the map again. This is called *rendering*. If you untick this box, QGIS stops redrawing the map canvas. This is handy when you

		change many settings in a large project, because you do not have to wait each time for the map to be drawn again. Tick it, and QGIS will draw the layers in the map canvas again.
D6	**Current CRS**	Shows which coordinate system is currently active in your project. See the chapter on coordinate systems, in particular Coordinate system of the QGIS project.
D7	**Log Messages**	This speech-bubble button opens the *Log Messages* panel, where QGIS posts messages about what it is doing: for example that a task has been completed, or a warning when a layer cannot be loaded.